

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 4 3
♥ 6
♦ A J 10 7
♣ K 10 6 4

♠ J
♥ K Q J 10 8 5
♦ 8 3
♣ A Q J 2



♠ A 10 9 8 2
♥ 9 4
♦ K 9 5 2
♣ 8 7

♠ 7 6 5
♥ A 7 3 2
♦ Q 6 4
♣ 9 5 3

West	North	East	South
1♦	1♥	1♠	2♥
2♠	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by North			

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠A then the ♠8.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 2 : Total = 5

You cannot avoid losing the two ♦s and since you have already lost a ♠ you must not lose any ♣s. So you have to find West with the ♣K. But that isn't all - you also need to get to dummy twice to make two finesses. The ♥A is one entry and the other one will have to be the ♥7.

Be very careful. Ruff the second ♠ with the ♥8 saving your ♥5. Pull one round of trumps with ♥K, then lead ♥10 to dummy (still saving the ♥5). Play a ♣ and finesse the ♣J. Lead your ♥5 to dummy's ♥7, then another ♣, finessing the ♣Q. Now play ♣A and ruff your last ♣ with dummy's last ♥.

When entries are scarce look at the suits where you have a fit. Sometimes you can find an extra entry by unblocking high spot cards in one hand.

If you hadn't been able to find that extra entry you would have had no choice but to play West for the doubleton ♣ K x.

You surely want to compete and must choose between a Takeout Double and an overcall.

To make a Takeout Double followed by a bid of your own suit you should have 17 points or more. Since you don't quite measure up you overcall 1♥. The opponents find a ♠ fit and partner raises your ♥s.

If you bid 3♥ now partner would not take it as invitational, he would just assume you were competing for the partscore.

The truth is that you don't know if you can make game or not. If you are feeling very conservative then perhaps a 3♥ bid is ok. But the bold will bid 4♥.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠A then the ♠8.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 3 2
 ♥ Q 6 4
 ♦ 9 7 4 2
 ♣ 8 2

♠ 8 6

♥ 10 9 7 5

♦ 10

♣ K J 9 7 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 9 7 5

♥ J 2

♦ A K 5 3

♣ A Q

♠ 10 4

♥ A K 8 3

♦ Q J 8 6

♣ 10 6 4

West

North

East

South

2 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

Make a choice. With 20 points you are strong enough to open 2NT. But, with two doubletons you can't really call this a balanced hand. So you should open 1 ♠.

Partner responds 2 ♠.

There should be no doubt about this bid. Partner has at least 6 points so you know there is enough for game. You bid 4 ♠.

East plays 4 ♠. South leads ♥A, ♥K, ♥3 and North follows to all three.

East plays 4 ♠. South leads ♥A, ♥K, ♥3 and North follows to all three.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 5

The 5 loser count isn't actually right because at this point you can dump one of those losers on dummy's ♥Q. The question is: Which one?

You have two chances to set up an extra winner - if the ♦s split 3-2 or if the ♣K is with North. If you discard the ♣Q right now you will be pinning all your hopes on the ♦ split. By discarding a ♦ instead you keep both possibilities alive.

So discard the ♦. Pull trumps with ♠ A J (it takes two rounds) then play ♦A and ♦K. Bad news, North shows out. So now you take your second chance. Enter dummy with a trump and play a ♣, finessing North for the ♣K. Good news, this works. Two chances are better than one.

You might have thought it was better to discard the ♣Q rather than a ♦ because the ♣ finesse was only a 50% chance while the chance of a 3-2 ♦ split was much better than that.

The percentages are right but the logic is wrong. If you are going to benefit from a 3-2 ♦ split it is only necessary for you to keep 4 ♦s in **one** of the hands, not both. So the fourth ♦ in your hand was unimportant while the ♣Q gave you an extra shot.